Arijit Sen (He/Him)
Data Editor at Scientific American

Experience

Data Editor
Scientific American · Full-time
Jan 2026 - Present · 2 mos
Washington, District of Columbia, United States

Investigative Data Journalist
CBS News and Stations · Full-time
Feb 2024 - Dec 2025 · 1 yr 11 mos

- Spearheaded an investigation into criminal police officers who work off-duty jobs, juggling stakeholders from around the country
- Built tools to track mass shootings, Olympic and Paralympic medals and ransomware attacks at schools.


How police departments' loosely-written and poorly-enforced rules enable off-duty police...


Ransomware attacks on schools threaten student data nationwide

The Dallas Morning News
2 yrs 9 mos

Computational Journalist
Full-time
Jun 2022 - Feb 2024 · 1 yr 9 mos
Dallas, Texas, United States

- Served as the main data reporter on a IRE Award-winning and Livingston finalist series on preventable trauma deaths.
- Authored a two-part investigative series revealing systemic surveillance of student social media data by 38 colleges across the country, revealing specific targeting of campus protestors and activists. The stories led two major colleges to end their use of the service and spawned a state legislative inquiry.
- Voted The Dallas Morning News' 2022 Investigative Reporter of the Year, in my first year on the job.
- Revealed the surveillance of millions of Texas' students by their schools in a Sunday front-page story. This story won the Northern California Society of Professional Journalists James Madison Freedom of Information award.
- Wrote a Python script to assess the impacts of prison gerrymandering in Texas for a Sunday front-page story. This story was a runner-up for the 2023 Harry Frank Guggenheim Excellence in Criminal Justice Reporting Award.
- Routinely wrote code to scrape, parse, analyze, mine and visualize data for long-term and breaking news stories.


Bleeding Out: Trauma deserts in rural America: Where you live can determine whether you live


How Dallas police failed to stop Officer Christopher Hess' streak of violence


AI flagged 'irrelevant' posts as unsafe at colleges, investigation shows

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Contract Investigative Reporter

Contract
Aug 2021 - Jun 2022 · 11 mos

- Revealed systemic surveillance of Texas' students by their schools in a Sunday front-page, single-byline story.
- Created an interactive map and searchable table to accompany the surveillance story
- Filed public records requests for documents from every public college in the state of Texas
- Performed data analysis/visualization in SQL, Python, QGIS, Excel, Google Sheets and Tableau
- Contributing to reporting on misconduct in the Dallas Police Department.



Uvalde CISD purchased social media monitoring service years before shooting

Flashlight beatings, chokings and threats: Dallas officer faced multiple allegations of...
I contributed reporting to this story which reveals an officer's 20+ year history of misconduct on...

Texas schools are surveilling students online, often without their knowledge or consent
Texas schools are rapidly scaling up the use of technology that monitors email, web history an...

Data and Investigative Intern

Internship
Jun 2021 - Aug 2021 · 3 mos
Dallas, Texas, United States

AI Accountability Fellow

Pulitzer Center on Crisis Reporting · Part-time
Jun 2022 - Sep 2023 · 1 yr 4 mos

- Part of the inaugural class of Pulitzer Center AI Accountability Fellows.
- Receiving nearly $18k to further my reporting on a social media monitoring service used by colleges nationwide.



Arijit Douglas Sen

Pulitzer Center Announces First Cohort of AI Accountability Fellows

Freelance Contributor

NBC News
Aug 2020 - Jun 2022 · 1 yr 11 mos

- Published a story about the massive scope of QAnon pages and groups on Facebook
- Working with members of the investigative and tech teams to report stories



QAnon groups have millions of members on Facebook, documents show
The preliminary results of an investigation by Facebook shed new light on the scope of activi...

Investigative Reporting Teaching Assistant

University of California, Berkeley · Part-time
Jul 2021 - Aug 2021 · 2 mos

- Co-taught lectures on investigative reporting techniques with Pulitzer Prize-winning reporter Thomas Peele
- Worked with undergraduate students on investigative story pitches and evaluated their work

Data Researcher
KQED · Part-time
Mar 2021 - Aug 2021 · 6 mos

- Analyzed police records and inputting data as part of the California Reporting Project, a statewide multi-newsroom collaboration effort to hold law enforcement agencies accountable.
- Wrote Python scripts to automate parts of the case intake process saving myself and my colleagues hours of time.

Research Assistant
Investigative Reporting Program
Sep 2020 - Dec 2020 · 4 mos
Berkeley, California, United States

- Investigated failures of the national child welfare system
- Acquired and reviewed public documents, compiled reporting memos and interviewed sources relating to the child welfare project.

Reporter
Oakland North
Aug 2020 - Dec 2020 · 5 mos
Oakland, California, United States

- Reported five stories on education and local politics in Oakland
- Planned, coordinated and ran election day coverage for the site
- Working with other reporters to create data visualizations and advise on data-heavy projects

Ballot measure could increase OUSD teacher diversity, draw legal challenges
There is perhaps no more commonly spoken word in Oakland Unified School Board meeting...

Oakland North Election Day Live Blog

CA Proposition 15 could bring millions to Oakland Schools, new burdens to businesses...
Voters will decide next month whether to approve a ballot measure which could provide ...

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Reporter
UNC Global Storytelling
Jan 2020 - May 2020 · 5 mos
Chapel Hill, North Carolina, United States

- Contributed to the College Photographer of the Year and Horizon Interactive Award-winning project "Barriers" by reporting and writing an in-depth feature story on the decline of the Mayan chocolate industry in Belize
- Shot several images which were published alongside the written story
- Contributed cinematography for the documentary portion of the package, which won a Bronze medal in its category for the College Photographer of the Year Awards.
- Collaborated with a team of five other journalists across mediums to produce a compelling multimedia package



Bittersweet | Barriers: The changing relationship between humans and the...
The dying art of Mayan chocolate production

Staff Writer and Fact-Checker
Lead Stories
Dec 2019 - Mar 2020 · 4 mos
Chapel Hill, North Carolina

- Published several pieces online which dispelled rumors about Nancy Pelosi, Adam Schiff, Alexandria Ocasio-Cortez, Hillary

Clinton, Donald Trump and other major political figures
- Helped remove tens of thousands of links to inaccurate or false news stories on Facebook
- Used a AI social media tool to identify fake news as soon as it became viral
- Used open-source social media info to investigate claims of and Iranian drone strike



Fake News: CA Gov. Newsom Did NOT Pardon 1342 Prisoners So ICE Couldn't Deport Them...
Did California Gov. Gavin Newsom pardon 1,342 prisoners so they couldn't be deported by...



Fake News: Two Star Witnesses Against Biden NOT Found Floating In River Ukraine | Lead...
Were two witnesses against former Vice President Joe Biden found dead in the River...



Fake News: Iranian Ballistic Missiles Did NOT Hit The Largest US Military Base In Iraq | Lea...
UPDATE: Iran announced on January 7, 2020, that the country had attacked bases in Iraq...

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Reporter
Our Chatham
Oct 2018 - Mar 2020 · 1 yr 6 mos
Chapel Hill, NC

- Reported a story exposing the politics behind the repeal of a developer fee and its ramifications
- Mapped internet speeds across every Census block in the county for a story about broadband access
- Routinely used SQL and GIS software to analyze and visualize data for stories
- Shot and produced video and photo content for stories on a local Confederate statue

Amid outcry, Chatham Commissioners vote to begin statue removal process
After months of public and private debate, Chatham County's Board of Commissioners...

Why is high-speed internet still poor in Chatham County?
Our map shows the patchwork of Internet speeds across the county. About a quarter of residents...

What's up with impact fees in Chatham County?
There's an invisible target on Chatham County's back. A threat looming, with potential to damag...

Investigative Unit Intern
NBC News
Aug 2019 - Dec 2019 · 5 mos

- Co-authored a series of investigative stories about a senior State Department official who embellished her resume, which was followed by nearly every national news outlet, generated millions of web page views and ultimately led her to resign.
- Pitched and reported a single byline story about UNC spying on student activists with surveillance technology
- Co-authored an investigative piece about the EU Ambassador's dealings in Ukrainian oil and gas interests as part of NBC's impeachment coverage
- Contributed to stories about Purdue Pharma's opioid settlement and Hunter Biden's dealings in Romania

Senior Trump admin official Mina Chang resigns after embellishing resumé
Mina Chang resigned Monday, six days after an NBC News report about her resume inflation an...

Sondland backed the effort to 'shake up' the leadership at Ukraine's state energy company
The Ukrainian government saw Sondland's push as part of a broader effort linked to Giuliani and...

UNC police used geofencing tech to monitor antiracism protestors
Police used the technology to collect info from a protest at a Confederate statue on the UNC...

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Reporter
UNC FactCheck
May 2019 - Aug 2019 · 4 mos
Chapel Hill,NC

- Reported five stories on the Ninth District special election
- Analyzed campaign finance data for the team of reporters
- Fact-checked claims made by the candidates, media and political special interest groups on healthcare, voter integrity and other issues



UNC FactCheck: 9th District candidates spar on health care
Story by Molly Weisner and Ari Sen In the North Carolina's 9th Congressional District race, healt...

UNC FactCheck: "Voter Integrity Project" spreading misinformation about absentee...
By Ari Sen With additional reporting by Matthew Langston. Last Wednesday night, President...

Intern
Asheville Citizen-Times
Jun 2017 - Aug 2017 · 3 mos
Asheville, North Carolina Area

- Published more than a dozen front page stories in ten-week period
- Wrote more than 60 stories which generated tens of thousands of web clicks
- Produced photo and video content for the Citizen-Times website and print edition
- Reported a series of stories about alleged murderer who led police on a six county manhunt
- Routinely covered breaking news across the crime, politics and education beats.



Bigfoot sighting in McDowell: Fur-clad tourist claims responsibility
Fur-clad Sasquatch worshiper claims McDowell bigfoot sighting



Stroupe may face death penalty for murder, kidnapping charges
Stroupe to face death penalty for murder, kidnapping of Mills River man



Fugitive seen in Mills River as community supports searchers
As search continues community support abounds

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The Daily Tar Heel
9 mos

Web Desk Assistant
Jan 2017 - May 2017 · 5 mos
Chapel Hill, North Carolina

- Prepared and edited online stories for publication
- Wrote social media copy for Facebook and Twitter

- Used HTML and CSS to improve visual presentation

Staff Writer
Sep 2016 - Jan 2017 · 5 mos
Chapel Hill, North Carolina

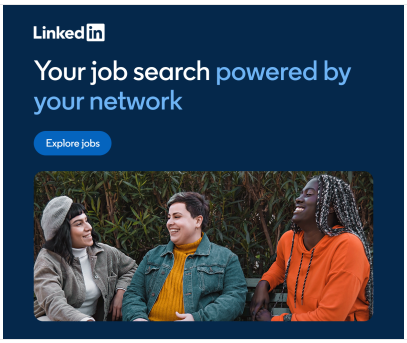
- Reported on Barack Obama, Donald Trump, Tim Kaine and N.C. Gov. Pat McCrory campaign events during the 2016 election season.
- Covered politics, healthcare, education, business and civil rights as part of the State and National desk

Web Editor-in-Chief
Wingspan Newspaper
Aug 2014 - Jun 2016 · 1 yr 11 mos

- Recipient of the 2016 NCSMA Journalist of the Year award
- Under my supervision, Wingspan Online won a Pacemaker Finalist Award, a Second Place Best of Show Award from the National Scholastic Press Association, two Columbia Scholastic Press Association Silver Crowns and three North Carolina Scholastic Media Association Tar Heel Awards.
- Exposed a pattern of racially disproportionate suspensions in Henderson County schools.
- Redesigned the school's newsmagazine and website from scratch using the Adobe Creative Cloud Suite and WordPress
- Supervised a staff of over 50 student reporters

Contributor
Carolina Public Press
Dec 2015 - Mar 2016 · 4 mos
Asheville, North Carolina Area

- Reviewed public records for an investigative story as part of my high school senior project
- Shot several photographs for CPP's primary election coverage
- Wrote an article summarizing a recent forum event



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John Kelly · 1st
VP of Data Journalism, CBS News and Stations. Leading data-driven and forensic journalism. Reporting the news while inventing data, AI,...
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Steve Reilly · 1st
Investigative Data Journalist
Message

Jeff Hargarten · 2nd
Data Journalist at Star Tribune

Connect



Kristie Song · 2nd
California Local News Fellow

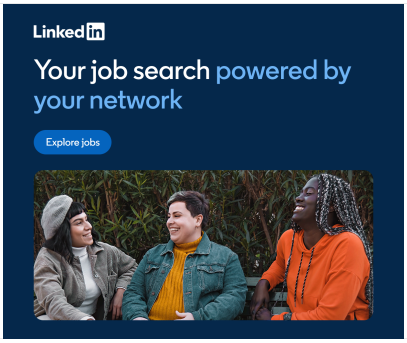
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Taylor Johnston · 1st
Visual Data Journalist at CBS News

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